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Insights from the Global Foundational Learning Action Tracker 2025

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Introduction

Foundational learning lays the groundwork for the essential skills children need to reach their full potential. Mastering basic literacy, numeracy and socio-emotional skills unlocks opportunities for children to learn, thrive and participate meaningfully in society. Yet, far too many children are not acquiring foundational learning: Globally, about two thirds of children are estimated to be in learning poverty, unable to read and understand a simple text by age 10.

The Foundational Learning Action Tracker strengthens accountability and progress on foundational learning. Launched by UNICEF and the Hempel Foundation in 2023, the Foundational Learning Action Tracker (FLAT) monitors government actions aimed at improving foundational learning in low- and middle-income countries. The tool is structured around the RAPID Framework developed by the Global Coalition for Foundational Learning. The Framework focuses on five key dimensions to accelerate learning: (i) Reach every child and keep them in school; (ii) Assess learning levels regularly; (iii) Prioritize teaching the fundamentals; (iv) Increase the efficiency of instruction; and (v) Develop psychosocial health and well-being.

This report presents findings from FLAT 2025, covering a total of 124 low- and middle-income countries. First, a global survey was conducted between June to September 2025 to gather information on the extent to which countries are implementing RAPID policy actions for foundational learning. Survey responses were received from 79 UNICEF country offices, of which 82 per cent responded in consultation with their Ministry of Education (MoE) counterparts.[1] Second, data on countries' systems strengthening efforts for foundational learning were collected through UNICEF's annual internal monitoring and reporting exercise with its country offices, covering 119 countries. Combining the two sources, data on policy action and/or systems strengthening are available for a total of 124 countries. The FLAT uses a 4-point rating scale to describe countries' level of progress: (1) Not yet initiating, (2) Initiating, (3) Established, and (4) Championing. As the data are self-reported and country participation varies across years, the results should be interpreted with caution (*see Box 1*).

With three years of data, the FLAT highlights where countries are making strides and where greater efforts are needed to accelerate progress on foundational learning. Findings from FLAT 2023 and FLAT 2024 underscored the urgency of scaling up evidence-based interventions and ensuring systems are in place to support the effective implementation of RAPID actions. FLAT 2025 examines leading indicators – where sustained or strengthened progress has been achieved at scale – and lagging indicators – where progress has stalled or remains below scale. The report begins with the RAPID 5 – a set of indicators that represent the essential ingredients needed for accelerating progress on foundational learning. Drawing on the broader set of data captured by the FLAT, the subsequent chapters then present findings for each of the five RAPID dimensions.

FLAT 2025 places a spotlight on teachers – the cornerstone of every child's right to quality education. Evidence shows that one of the most powerful school-based factors influencing a child's learning is the quality of their teacher.[2] In the classroom, teachers bring to life the curricula, tools and intervention programmes that are introduced to support learning. However, for teachers to be effective, countries must invest in the right training, systems, resources and working conditions that enable educators to succeed. FLAT 2025 presents new data on countries' actions to support teachers, reflecting their pivotal role in ensuring every child acquires foundational learning and the skills they need to thrive.

Box 1. Methodological Note

The FLAT uses two main data sources: (i) a RAPID survey conducted with UNICEF country offices and MoEs, and (ii) UNICEF's annual monitoring and reporting exercise with its programme countries. Each data source is described below, along with the method of calculation for their respective ratings presented in this report.

RAPID SURVEY

The survey builds on previous RAPID surveys by UNICEF and partner organizations from the Global Coalition for Foundational Learning, dating back to March 2022.[3,4,5] Significant revisions were made to the survey in 2024, including item analysis to reduce the number of survey items as well as a series of consultations to introduce new indicators constituting the RAPID 5. Following a technical review, most survey items were retained in 2025. Some new survey items were also added: an indicator on child protection, follow-up questions on the types of targeted instruction programmes provided and qualitative questions on RAPID actions on inclusive education.

The RAPID survey was conducted between June to September 2025, with a total of 88 country responses collected from UNICEF country offices and/or MoEs. As the FLAT focuses on low- and middle-income countries, this report presents data from the 79 low- and middle-income countries that responded to the survey, including a response from the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province of Pakistan. Among the respondents, 82 per cent reported that the MoE was consulted on some or all survey items. The RAPID survey asks countries to report on the scope at which policy actions are currently being implemented at the primary level. Table 1 presents how each scope of implementation was defined by the response options in the survey.

Several measures were taken to ensure the accuracy of the data, including encouraging consultation with MoEs in survey response, data triangulation with external sources where possible (e.g., UNESCO Institute for Statistics database) and data validation by the FLAT Technical Reference Group. However, due to the self-reported nature of the survey, several limitations remain, including potential for bias, varying interpretations of survey items and differing perceptions among respondents. In some cases, responses reflect estimates rather than systematic data, due to limited availability or the absence of regular data collection. These limitations should be taken into account when interpreting the data.

UNICEF INTERNAL MONITORING AND REPORTING EXERCISE

UNICEF conducts an annual comprehensive monitoring and reporting exercise with its programme country offices for its performance management and reporting. The annual exercise includes indicators (with multiple sub-dimensions) related to equitable and inclusive access to learning opportunities and improved learning, effectiveness of assessment systems, digital learning, skills, and adolescent participation and engagement.

Relevant indicators from this exercise were mapped against each dimension of the RAPID Framework, with a total of

TABLE 1. RAPID survey response options on scope of implementation

RAPID DIMENSION	RESPONSE OPTIONS FOR SCOPE OF IMPLEMENTATION			
Reach every child and keep them in school; Assess learning levels regularly; Prioritize teaching the fundamentals	Nationwide implementation (at central, sub-national and school levels)	Partial implementation (at sub-national level, including selected regions/sub-regions and schools in those regions/sub-regions)	Small-scale implementation (at school level only, including in selected schools only – even if across multiple regions – and pilot programme efforts)	No implementation
Increase the efficiency of instruction	Nationwide implementation (in all schools)	Partial implementation (in more than half of, but not all, schools)	Small-scale implementation (in few schools)	No implementation
Develop psychosocial health and well-being	Nationwide implementation (at central, sub-national and school levels)	Partial implementation (at sub-national level, including selected regions/sub-regions and schools in those regions/sub-regions)	Small-scale implementation (at school level only, including in selected schools only – even if across multiple regions – and pilot programme efforts)	No implementation

119 countries having data for at least one indicator. Each indicator includes defined criteria to guide countries in reporting the level of effectiveness of key education system aspects, such as learning assessment systems (mapped to the RAPID dimension of 'Assess learning levels regularly') and teacher development systems (mapped to the RAPID dimension of 'Increase the efficiency of instruction').

METHOD OF CALCULATION

For each RAPID dimension, three types of ratings were computed for each country: policy action, systems strengthening and overall rating.

1. To compute a **policy action rating** for a RAPID dimension, responses to relevant survey items were converted to a 4-point scale based on the scope of implementation reported for each policy measure, from 1 ('No implementation') to 4 ('Nationwide implementation'). For items not based on implementation scope (e.g., average textbook-student ratio), responses were converted using defined cut-points (e.g., a score of 4 for 1:1 ratio). The average of these scores across indicators was calculated to produce the country's policy action rating.
2. To compute a **systems strengthening** rating for a RAPID dimension, data are derived from the respective RAPID indicator mapped in UNICEF's internal monitoring exercise. Each indicator is assessed using a standardized matrix that is already aligned to a 4-point scale, based on established criteria and methodology.
3. To compute an **overall rating** for a RAPID dimension, the average of the policy action rating and the systems strengthening rating was calculated. If only one of the two ratings was available, that score was used as the overall rating.

This process results in three ratings – policy action, systems strengthening and overall – for each of the five RAPID dimensions. The 4-point scale corresponds to the following increasing levels of progress: (1) Not yet initiating, (2) Initiating, (3) Established, and (4) Championing. The average of the five overall ratings is computed to produce a single overall rating.

For countries with missing 2025 data, updated 2024 policy action and systems strengthening ratings (described in the next section) were used, based on the assumption that efforts had not significantly changed since 2024. Imputation was applied to at least one RAPID dimension in 47 countries. Combining actual and imputed data, FLAT 2025 ratings were produced for a total of 124 low- and middle-income countries.

UPDATING 2024 RATINGS

To make FLAT ratings comparable across years, policy action ratings for each RAPID dimension were adjusted to include only survey items that were retained in 2025. The modified 2024 ratings were then used for comparisons against 2025 ratings. In this analysis, a change greater than or equal to 0.5 is considered an increase, and a change less than or equal to -0.5 is considered a decrease.

A total of 79 responses from low- and middle-income countries were collected in 2025, compared to 89 responses in 2024. To test for potential selection bias, two sets of comparisons of FLAT ratings were made: first, comparing all countries responding in 2025 and all countries responding in 2024 (a combined total of 119 countries); and second, restricted to the 60 countries that submitted survey responses in both years. The patterns were consistent across both groups, suggesting minimal selection bias: In each case, about 10 per cent of countries showed an increase in ratings, and just over 80 per cent showed no change.

RAPID 5

PROGRESS AT A GLANCE

The RAPID 5 tracks the five most fundamental ingredients needed to support foundational learning. A subset of indicators from the broader FLAT, the RAPID 5 represents key indicators to drive progress:

» Average textbook-student ratio in the early grades (Grades 1–3);

» Clearly defined learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy;

» Regular nationally representative large-scale assessment of reading and/or math in the early grades (Grades 2/3);

» Utilization of assessment data to inform classroom practices and education policy and planning; and

» Evidence-based programmes to improve FLN at scale.

LEADING INDICATOR: Clearly defined learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy nationwide, reported by 81 per cent in 2025 (78 per cent in 2024).

LAGGING INDICATOR: Evaluated, evidence-based programme to improve FLN implemented nationwide, reported by 30 per cent in 2025 (26 per cent in 2024).

TABLE 2. RAPID 5 criteria

RAPID 5	NOT YET INITIATING (1)	INITIATING (2)	ESTABLISHED (3)	CHAMPIONING (4)
Average textbook-student ratio in the early grades (Grades 1–3)	There are more than 5 students per reading textbook.	There are 3–5 students per reading textbook.	There are 2 students per reading textbook.	Reading textbooks are provided on a 1:1 basis.
Clearly defined learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy	Learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN have not been defined in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy.	Learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN are clearly defined in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy for some schools.	Learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN are clearly defined in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy at sub-national level.	Learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN are clearly defined in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy at national level.
Regular nationally representative large-scale assessment of reading and/or math in the early grades (Grades 2/3)	There is no nationally representative large-scale learning assessment of reading and/or math in the early grades.	There is a nationally representative large-scale learning assessment of reading and/or math in the early grades administered every 4 or more years.	There is a nationally representative large-scale learning assessment of reading and/or math in the early grades administered every 2 or 3 years.	There is a nationally representative large-scale learning assessment of reading and/or math in the early grades administered every year.
Utilization of assessment data to inform classroom practices and education policy and planning	Assessment data are used to inform classroom practices and/or education policy and planning for primary education on only a small scale (e.g., selected schools) or not at all.	Assessment data are used to inform classroom practices and/or education policy and planning for primary education on a regional/sub-national scale.	Assessment data are used to inform either classroom practices or education policy and planning for primary education on a nationwide scale.	Assessment data are used to inform both classroom practices and education policy and planning for primary education on a nationwide scale.
Evidence-based programmes to improve FLN at scale	At least one evidence-based programme for FLN at the primary education level is implemented for only few schools.	At least one evidence-based programme for FLN at the primary education level is implemented in more than half of, but not all, schools.	At least one evidence-based programme for FLN at the primary education level is implemented nationwide in all schools.	At least one evaluated and evidence-based programme for FLN at the primary education level is implemented nationwide in all schools.

The RAPID 5 spotlights the most essential, actionable levers for accelerating foundational learning. Introduced in 2024, the RAPID 5 is a subset of indicators from the broader FLAT, identified by experts and stakeholders as the most critical factors for progress. While the full FLAT provides a comprehensive view of government efforts, the RAPID 5 offers a focused lens on priority actions to help guide policymaking and advocacy. Data on the RAPID 5 indicators are transformed into a 4-point scale based on criteria as indicated in Table 2.

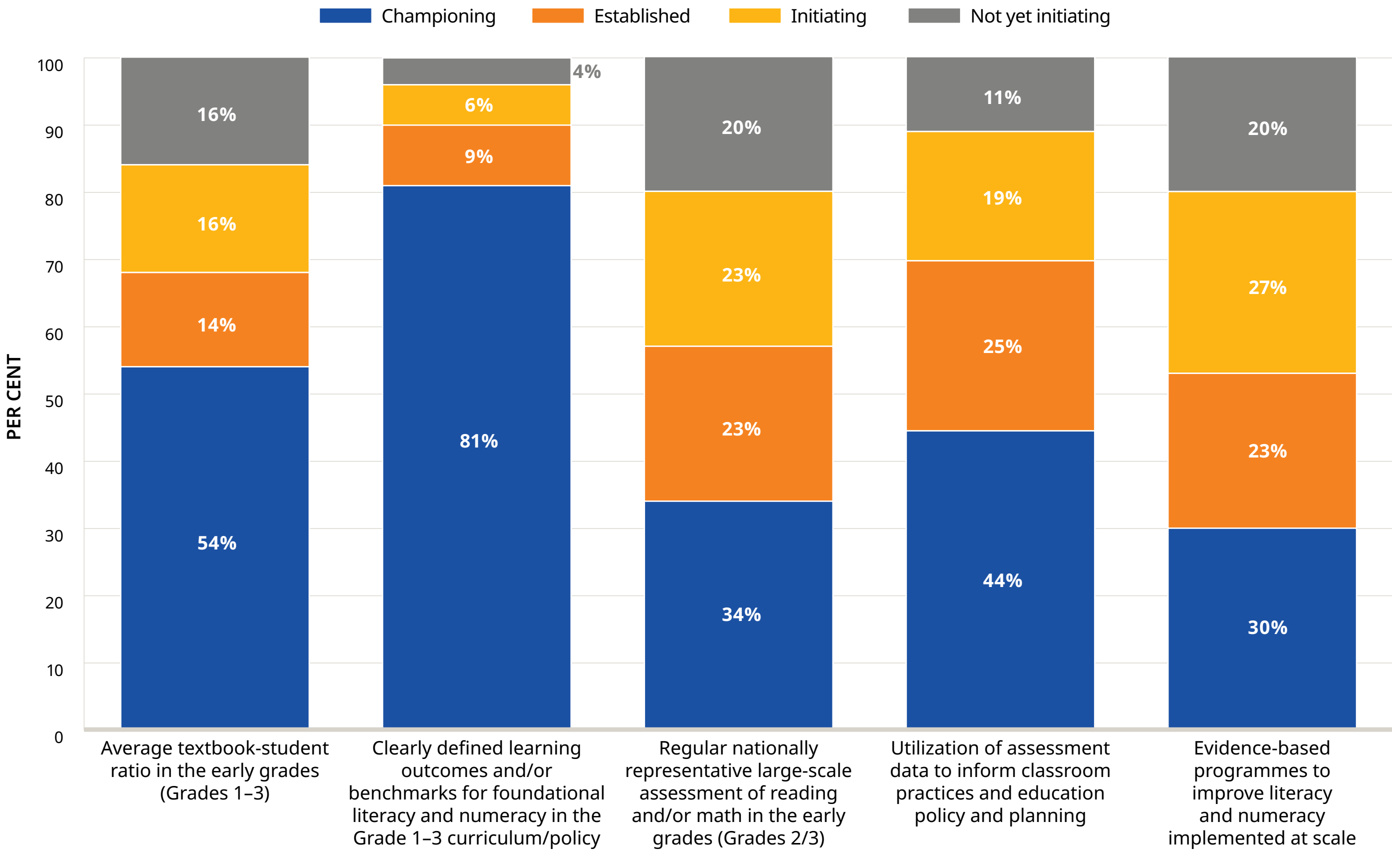
As with the findings from the broader RAPID survey, data on the RAPID 5 must be interpreted with caution due to several caveats. For some indicators (e.g., textbook-student ratio), countries were asked to identify the data source. While most cited national or sub-national administrative data, public reports or databases, about a fifth reported using estimates by UNICEF country office or MoE staff due to limited data availability. Five countries were unable to provide responses on textbook-student ratio, citing that such data is not tracked. Other caveats include the following:

- Data triangulation was conducted where possible; for example, survey information on nationally representative large-scale assessments in the early grades was cross-checked against global databases on Sustainable Development Goal Indicator 4.1.6 on learning assessments. However, data for other indicators, such as the existence of evidence-based programmes for FLN, is not systematically collected and reported in public databases.
- In the absence of data specific to the early grades, some countries used the next best available data (e.g., Grade 4 as a proxy for Grades 1–3).
- In some cases, information was based on existing policies (e.g., regulations requiring one textbook per student) but may not accurately reflect actual implementation (e.g., delays in textbook delivery).

Among the RAPID 5 indicators, large-scale action is most evident in the clear definition of FLN learning outcomes and/or benchmarks in early-grade curricula. Countries have sustained strong efforts in this area: Since 2024, about 8 in 10 have reported nationwide measures to define FLN benchmarks in the early-grade curriculum or policy. Fewer than 5 per cent report no action on this policy measure (*see Figure 1*).

However, progress appears to have stalled across most RAPID 5 indicators, with fewer countries reporting actions at scale and only modest improvements in uptake since 2024. Just over half of countries report providing one reading textbook per student in the early grades. Fewer than half of countries report using assessment data to inform both classroom practices and education policy and planning nationwide. Fewer than a third of countries

FIGURE 1. Share of countries by RAPID 5 rating



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2025 survey. Data for average textbook-student ratio represent responses from 74 low- and middle-income countries, while data for the remaining indicators represent responses from 79 countries.

report that at least one evidence-based programme to improve FLN has been implemented nationwide and has been evaluated. Moreover, these three indicators have seen only marginal gains since 2024 (*see Figure 2*).

Although action on learning assessment has seen improvement, the pace of progress remains slow.

The share of countries reporting an annual nationally representative large-scale assessment of reading and/or math in the early grades has improved from 24 per cent in 2024. Still, only about a third of countries report doing so in 2025. Accelerated, large-scale action across all RAPID 5 indicators is urgently needed to move the needle on foundational learning.

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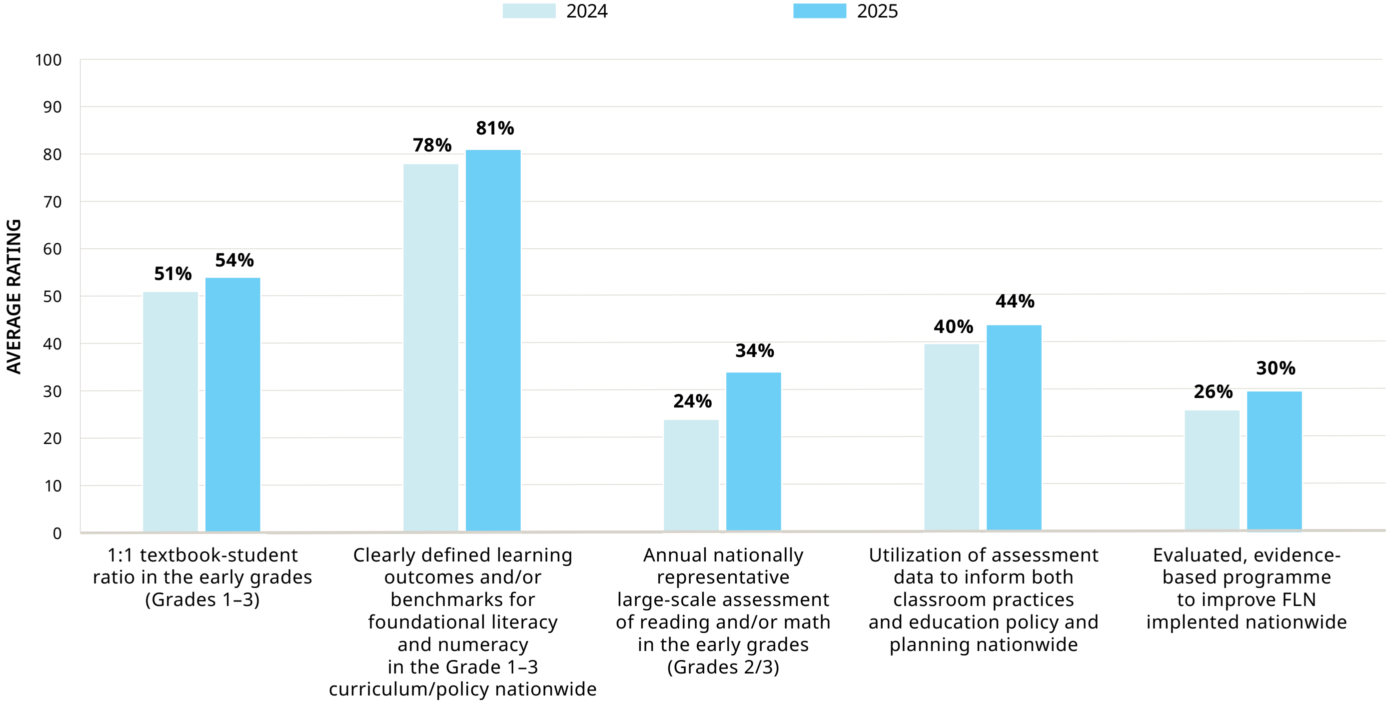
FIGURE 2. Share of countries at 'Championing' level for RAPID 5 indicators, by year



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2024 survey (N=83 for indicator on average textbook-student ratio; N=89 for all other indicators) and RAPID 2025 survey (N=74 for indicator on average textbook-student ratio; N=79 for all other indicators) surveys.

REACH

EVERY CHILD AND KEEP THEM IN SCHOOL

PROGRESS AT A GLANCE

Reaching every child and keeping them in school is a critical first step to achieving foundational learning for all. Education systems must identify students at risk of dropping out and address systemic barriers to schooling for vulnerable and marginalized groups. The FLAT tracks progress in this dimension through the following indicators, with the first three on policy actions (from the RAPID survey) and the last on systems strengthening (from UNICEF's internal monitoring and reporting exercise):

» Mechanisms to collect, report and act on information on student attendance;

» Mechanisms to collect, report and act on information on student dropout;

» Cash transfers or other types of support to increase enrolment among students from disadvantaged families; and

» Evidence-based education sector plan/strategy addressing inequities.

LEADING INDICATOR: Nationwide mechanisms to collect, report and act on information on student attendance, reported by 61 per cent of countries in 2025 (67 per cent in 2024; 57 per cent in 2023).

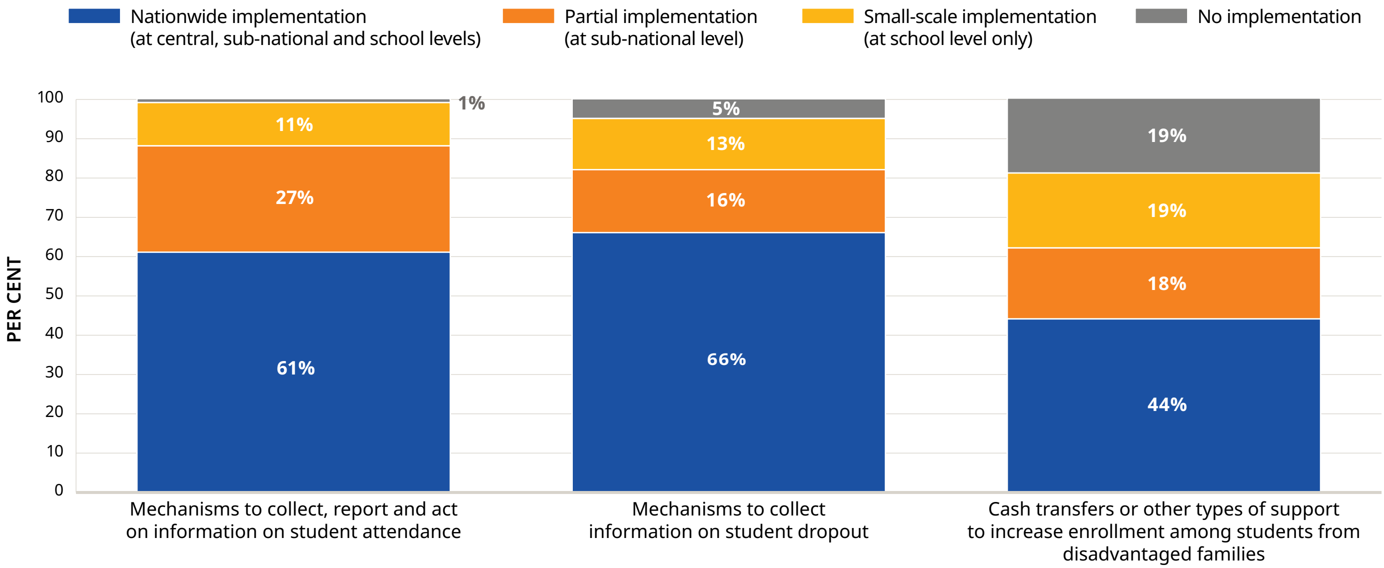
LAGGING INDICATOR: Evidence-based, comprehensive and measurable education sector plan/strategy, informed by recent analysis and implemented to address inequities in access, participation, retention and resource allocation, reported by 15 per cent in 2025 (12 per cent in 2024).

In 2025, over 6 in 10 countries report taking nationwide action to track student attendance and dropout. Encouragingly, nearly all countries in the survey report that measures on student attendance and dropout are being implemented at the primary level (*see* Figure 3). Over 60 per cent of countries have reported nationwide mechanisms to collect, report and act on information on student attendance since 2023, marking sustained action at scale on this policy measure. Regular and comprehensive tracking of student attendance is crucial to identify patterns of absenteeism early and enable targeted interventions.

However, fewer than half of countries report nationwide cash transfers or other types of support to increase enrolment among students from disadvantaged families. Showing no change from 2024, about a fifth of countries report no action on this measure in 2025. Providing support at scale through efforts such as cash transfers, school transport and the elimination of school fees is essential to reaching all disadvantaged students, ensuring that barriers to education are addressed.

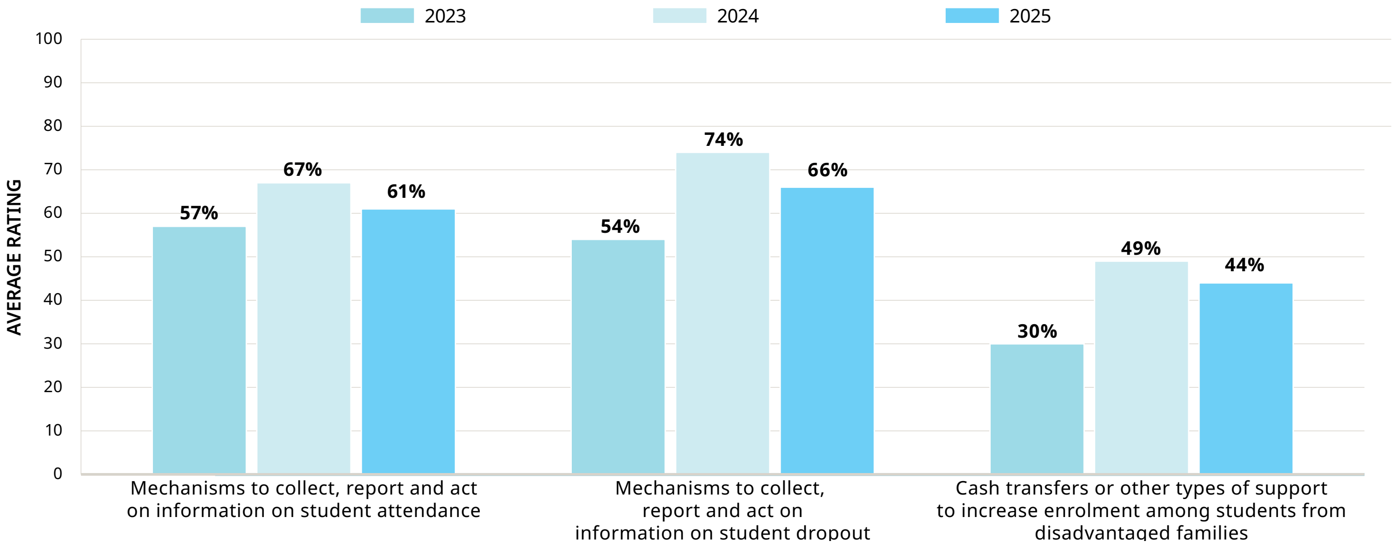
Overall, countries have sustained strong efforts to reach every child and keep them in school. On average, countries are progressing at the Established level, the third level in FLAT's 4-point rating scale, with momentum maintained since 2023. However, progress remains uneven: While many countries are taking action at scale, particularly in tracking student attendance and dropout, greater efforts are needed to support students from disadvantaged families (*see* Figure 4). Sustaining these targeted policies requires enabling systems that mitigate inequities in access, participation, retention and resource allocation. Showing no substantial improvement since 2024, just over 1 in 10 countries report that their national education sector strategies are evidence-based, updated, comprehensive, measurable and implemented to address inequities, while about a fifth still have only limited plans in place. Efforts to reach every child must also tackle issues in teacher allocation, deployment and retention – ensuring every child has access to qualified teachers (*see* Box 2).

FIGURE 3. Share of surveyed countries reporting implementation of 'Reach' policy actions



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2025 survey, with responses from 79 low- and middle-income countries.

FIGURE 4. Share of surveyed countries reporting nationwide implementation of 'Reach' policy actions, by year



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2023 (N=94), 2024 (N=89) and 2025 (N=79) surveys.

Box 2. Reaching Every Child: Teachers at the frontline

Efforts to improve teacher allocation and address inequities are evident across several countries, with many implementing targeted strategies to ensure more equitable distribution. The use of tools such as school maps in Cameroon and evidence such as the Teachers for All report in the Congo help identify inequities in teacher allocation. Incentives and hardship allowance for educators in remote areas are being implemented in countries like Armenia, the Gambia and Mongolia to attract teachers to underserved regions. Albania has also made strides by hiring assistant teachers and investing in professional development to help reduce inequities in resource allocation. Several countries are also strengthening teacher recruitment to support learners with diverse needs: In Bhutan, the Ministry of Education and Skills Development has integrated inclusive education considerations into teacher recruitment, while in Kosovo, teaching assistants are recruited to support children with disabilities in mainstream classrooms.[6]

Despite these initiatives, teacher deployment and retention in underserved areas remain persistent challenges. Some countries have no or only partial availability of incentives for deployment in the most deprived areas with teacher shortages, such as low-income or hard-to-reach areas. Even when such incentives are in place for teachers in remote or disadvantaged communities, challenges persist when these incentives are not adequate (e.g., lack of non-financial incentives such as accommodation) to attract teachers to work in these hardship locations. Furthermore, in some contexts, allowances are provided for teachers in certain subjects, leading to potential demotivation among teachers in other subjects. Stronger and more holistic incentive packages will be essential to ensuring that qualified teachers are not only deployed to underserved areas but also motivated to stay.

ASSESS
LEARNING LEVELS REGULARLY

PROGRESS AT A GLANCE

Assessing learning levels regularly ensures children's learning needs are met. At the classroom level, assessments help teachers adjust their instruction; at the system level, they allow policymakers to make informed decisions on where and how to mobilize resources. The FLAT tracks progress in this dimension through the following indicators, with the first six on policy actions (from the RAPID survey) and the last on systems strengthening (from UNICEF's internal monitoring and reporting exercise):

» Use of assessment data for intervention programmes on foundational learning;

» Use of assessment data to inform classroom practices;

» Use of assessment data to inform education policy and planning (e.g., curriculum review and/or reform);

» Use of assessment data to improve design of assessment instruments (e.g., choice of mother tongue as language of assessment);

» Support to teachers on assessments of foundational learning (e.g., developing and conducting assessments, utilizing assessment data);

» Regular nationally representative large-scale assessments of reading and/or math in the early grades (Grades 2/3); and

» Effectiveness of learning assessment systems.

LEADING INDICATOR: Use of assessment data for education policy and planning nationwide (e.g., curriculum review and/or reform), reported by 70 per cent in 2025 (65 per cent in 2024 for the same indicator).

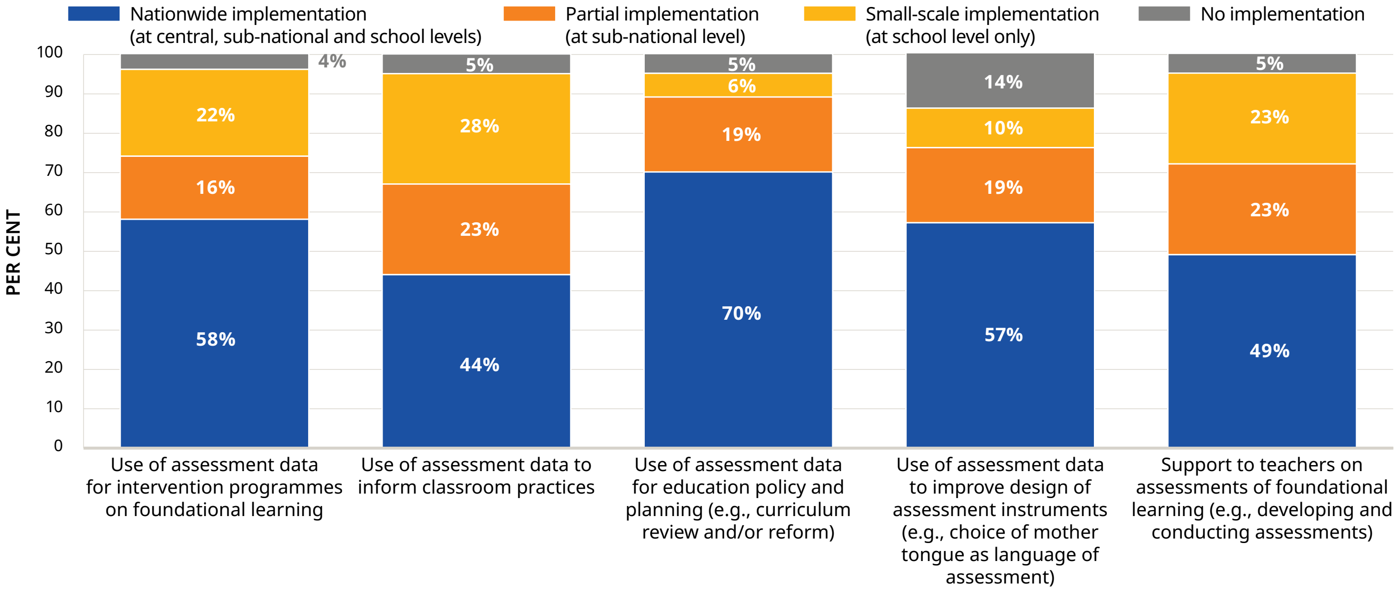
LAGGING INDICATOR: Use of assessment data to inform classroom practices in schools nationwide, reported by 44 per cent in 2025 (42 per cent in 2024).

The majority of countries report using assessment data to inform system-level decision-making. As observed in 2024, about 7 in 10 countries report using assessment data to inform education policy and planning nationwide (*see Figure 5*). Nearly 60 per cent of countries also report nationwide use of assessment data to inform intervention programmes on foundational learning and to improve the design of assessment instruments. However, gaps remain in the usage of assessment data at classroom level: Fewer than half of countries report that assessment data is used to inform classroom practices across schools nationwide.

About half of countries report that support on assessments is provided to teachers nationwide. This share of countries has increased from 43 per cent in 2024 and just 21 per cent in 2023. Still, in 2025, more than a quarter of countries report taking no or only small-scale action in this area. Supporting teachers throughout the assessment process, including developing and utilizing assessment data, is critical to meeting students' learning needs.

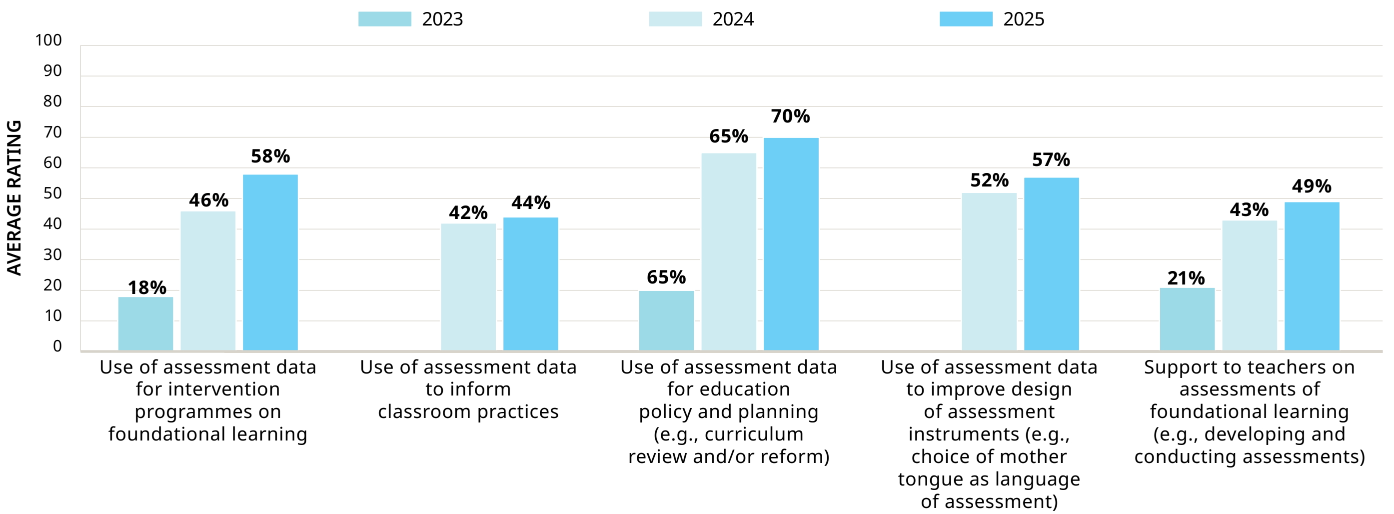
Overall, countries have established efforts to assess learning levels regularly, but significant gaps remain in the use of assessment data, teacher support and institutional capacity of assessment systems. On average, countries are rated at the Established level – the third level in FLAT's 4-point rating scale. To accelerate progress, increased efforts are especially needed at the classroom level, including in using assessment data to inform instruction and providing relevant teacher support at scale (*see Figure 6*). The effectiveness of learning assessment systems also remains a challenge: In 2025, only 5 per cent of countries report strong system-wide institutional capacity to support and ensure the quality of school-based, standardized and national large-scale assessments, supported by formal guidelines, curriculum alignment, and mechanisms for monitoring and analysis. Over 40 per cent of countries report having only weak or no such systems in place. Closing these gaps is essential to ensure assessment systems not only monitor learning effectively but also drive meaningful improvements in teaching and learning outcomes (*see Box 3*).

FIGURE 5. Share of surveyed countries reporting implementation of 'Assess' policy actions



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2025 survey, with responses from 79 low- and middle-income countries. The indicator on regular nationally representative large-scale assessments is excluded from the graph due to differing response options and is instead presented in the RAPID 5 chapter.

FIGURE 6. Share of surveyed countries reporting nationwide implementation of 'Assess' policy actions, by year



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2023 (N=94), 2024 (N=89) and 2025 (N=79) surveys. Indicators with no 2023 data were introduced in 2024.

Box 3. Making Learning Visible: Teachers at the heart of classroom assessment

Countries are increasingly investing in teacher training and support systems to improve the quality and use of classroom assessments. In Nigeria, South Sudan and Uganda, targeted training has focused on teachers' competence in formative and classroom-based assessments. Countries like Ghana, Lao People's Democratic Republic and Sao Tome and Principe are working to systematize and integrate classroom assessments into regular teaching and learning processes. Technology is also expanding the reporting and utilization of assessment data: In Rwanda, teachers use the Comprehensive Assessment Management Information System to track students' progress and grades continuously, while in Jordan, comprehensive dashboards in camp schools help teachers use assessment results to inform instruction. Notably, countries are also embedding inclusion in assessment practices: In Lesotho, for instance, pre-service teacher training curricula now includes a focus on assessing the learning needs of children with disabilities.

Despite these positive steps, many countries continue to face significant challenges in enabling teachers to implement effective, continuous assessment practices. Difficulties in ensuring consistent teacher training and implementation of assessments persist in several countries. While some countries have guidelines in place to support classroom assessments, gaps may still exist in corresponding teacher training. Assessment reforms are often undermined by limited guidance and supervision, resulting in reliance on one-off, end-of-term tests instead of continuous assessments. Even in countries where mechanisms are in place for regular formal assessments of systems, limited use of assessment data and weak feedback mechanisms underline the need for better follow-through. Strong system-level support, supervision and feedback mechanisms can help shift classroom assessments from merely documenting performance to actively improving teaching practices and students' learning outcomes.

PRIORITIZE
TEACHING THE FUNDAMENTALS

PROGRESS AT A GLANCE

Prioritizing teaching the fundamentals ensures children develop foundational literacy, numeracy and socio-emotional skills. Education systems can support this dimension by embedding these skills in curricula and teaching plans and institutionalizing holistic skills development. The FLAT tracks progress in this dimension through the following indicators, with the first three on policy actions (from the RAPID survey) and the last on systems strengthening (from UNICEF's internal monitoring and reporting exercise):

- Clearly defined learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN in the early grades (Grades 1–3);
- Integration of social-emotional learning in the curriculum;
- Average textbook-student ratio in the early grades (Grades 1–3); and
- Mainstreaming of transferable skills development within the national education system.

LEADING INDICATOR: Clearly defined learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy nationwide, reported by 81 per cent in 2025 (78 per cent in 2024 for the same indicator; 46 per cent in 2023 for 'curricular focus on FLN').

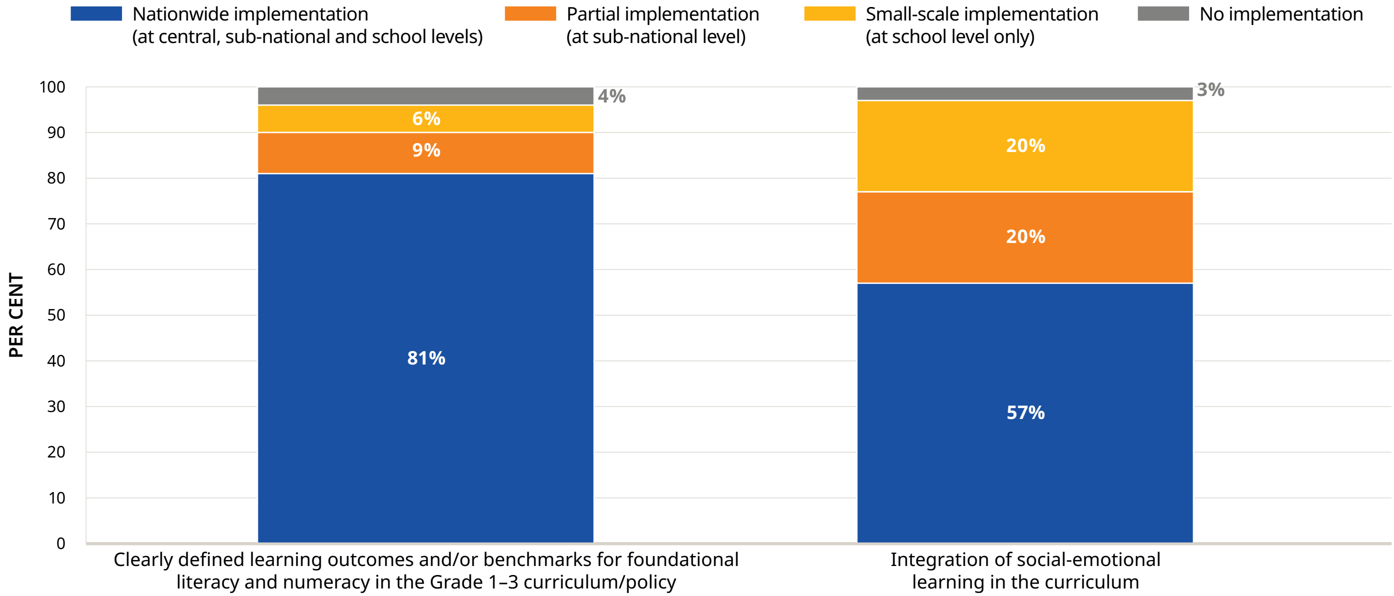
LAGGING INDICATOR: Integration of social-emotional learning in the curriculum nationwide, reported by 57 per cent in 2025 (44 per cent in 2024; 22 per cent in 2023).

As in 2024, about 8 in 10 countries report that learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN are clearly defined in the early-grade curriculum nationwide. In 2025, a mere 4 per cent of countries report having no such benchmarks in place (*see* Figure 7). Having clear standards for what students should learn ensures that assessment, curriculum and instruction are aligned to meet their learning needs. It also enables targeted interventions and accountability, helping to ensure all children acquire foundational learning.

However, only 57 per cent of countries report that social-emotional learning has been integrated into the curriculum nationwide. While this share of countries has steadily increased since 2023, adoption remains limited. In 2025, nearly a quarter of countries report no or only small-scale action in this area. Given that socio-emotional skills are fundamental to learning and linked to academic achievement and other positive life outcomes, scaling up implementation presents a valuable opportunity for countries to strengthen foundational learning.

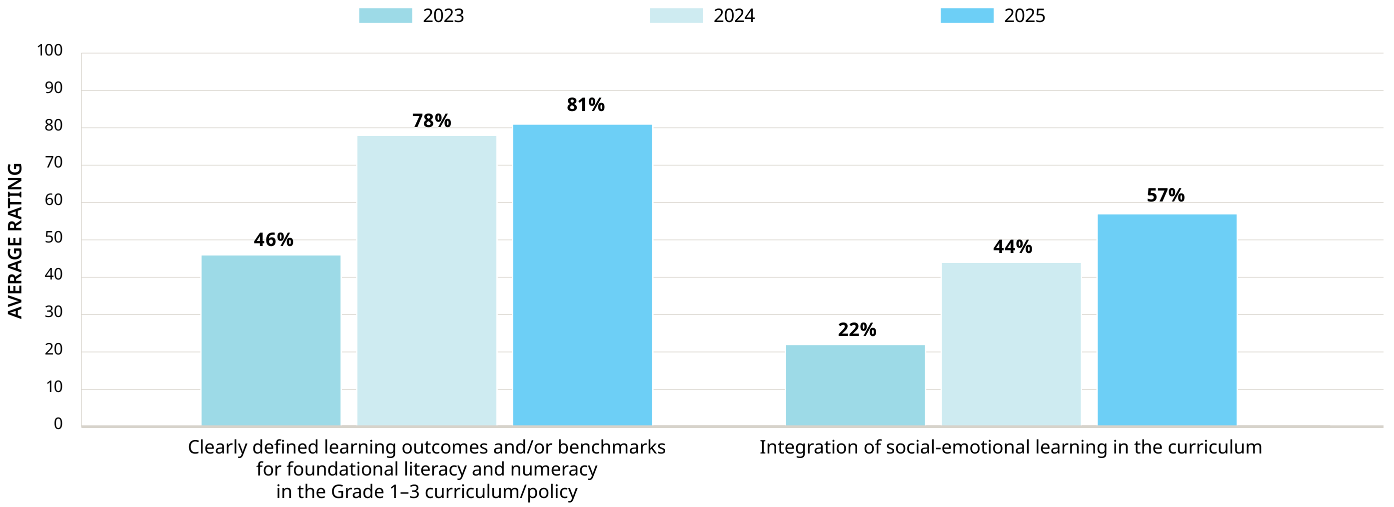
Overall, countries are sustaining progress to prioritize basic literacy and numeracy, but greater efforts are needed to support socio-emotional skills – an integral part of foundational learning. On average, countries are progressing at the Established level, the third level in FLAT's 4-point rating scale. Achieving gains in this dimension will require action at scale to holistically support foundational learning (*see* Figure 8). This includes addressing not only literacy and numeracy, but also socio-emotional skills, and strengthening teachers' capacity to teach these fundamentals (*see* Box 4). Moreover, holistic skills development must be mainstreamed within national education systems to effectively support learning. However, in 2025, almost half of countries report that transferable skills – also known as socio-emotional or life skills – are only partially or minimally integrated in formal and non-formal education systems, with persistent gaps in budgeting and human resources.

FIGURE 7. Share of surveyed countries reporting implementation of 'Prioritize' policy actions



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2025 survey, with responses from 79 low- and middle-income countries. The indicator on average textbook-student ratio in the early grades is excluded from the graph due to differing response options and is instead presented in the RAPID 5 chapter.

FIGURE 8. Share of surveyed countries reporting nationwide implementation of 'Prioritize' policy actions, by year



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2023 (N=94), 2024 (N=89) and 2025 (N=79) surveys. The indicator on 'clearly defined learning outcomes and/or benchmarks for FLN in the Grade 1–3 curriculum/policy' was originally worded as 'curricular focus on FLN' in 2023.

Box 4. Teaching the Fundamentals: Building teacher capacity

Countries are investing in coordinated initiatives to strengthen teacher capacity for delivering FLN skills. In Argentina, the Federal Literacy Network was established to serve as a systemic space for training, participation and communication with technical teams that include teachers, to support the implementation of literacy plans in their respective jurisdictions. In Rwanda, efforts are underway to train all lower primary school teachers in systematic phonics instruction to ensure all learners can read with comprehension by the end of Primary 3, while in Viet Nam, teacher training aligns with the competency-based general education curriculum that places a strong emphasis on Vietnamese language and mathematics in the early grades. Despite these advances, many systems continue to face barriers such as uneven training quality, resource constraints and limited mentoring support.

Countries are also undertaking various strategies to integrate transferable skills into education systems, often with a strong focus on enhancing teachers' capacity to deliver these competencies. Many countries have incorporated transferable skills into teacher training programmes, aiming to promote competencies like critical thinking, creativity and socio-emotional learning. For instance, in Montenegro, the Education Strategy Reform 2025–2035 includes a series of measures aimed at including a focus on socio-emotional and transversal skills in pre- and in-service teacher training programmes, while in Tunisia, local life skills have been integrated into the pre-service teacher training package. In countries like Armenia and Jamaica, teachers are capacitated to promote social-emotional learning in their regular teaching pedagogies. However, in many cases, budget constraints, limited infrastructure and gaps in teacher preparation continue to hinder the full integration of these skills, particularly in marginalized and underserved areas.

INCREASE
THE EFFICIENCY OF INSTRUCTION, INCLUDING THROUGH CATCH-UP LEARNING

PROGRESS AT A GLANCE

Increasing the efficiency of instruction entails using evidence-based strategies to support learning. Education systems should scale up proven interventions and ensure teachers have the skills and resources to implement them effectively. The FLAT tracks progress in this dimension through the following indicators, with the first three on policy actions (from the RAPID survey) and the last on systems strengthening (from UNICEF's internal monitoring and reporting exercise):

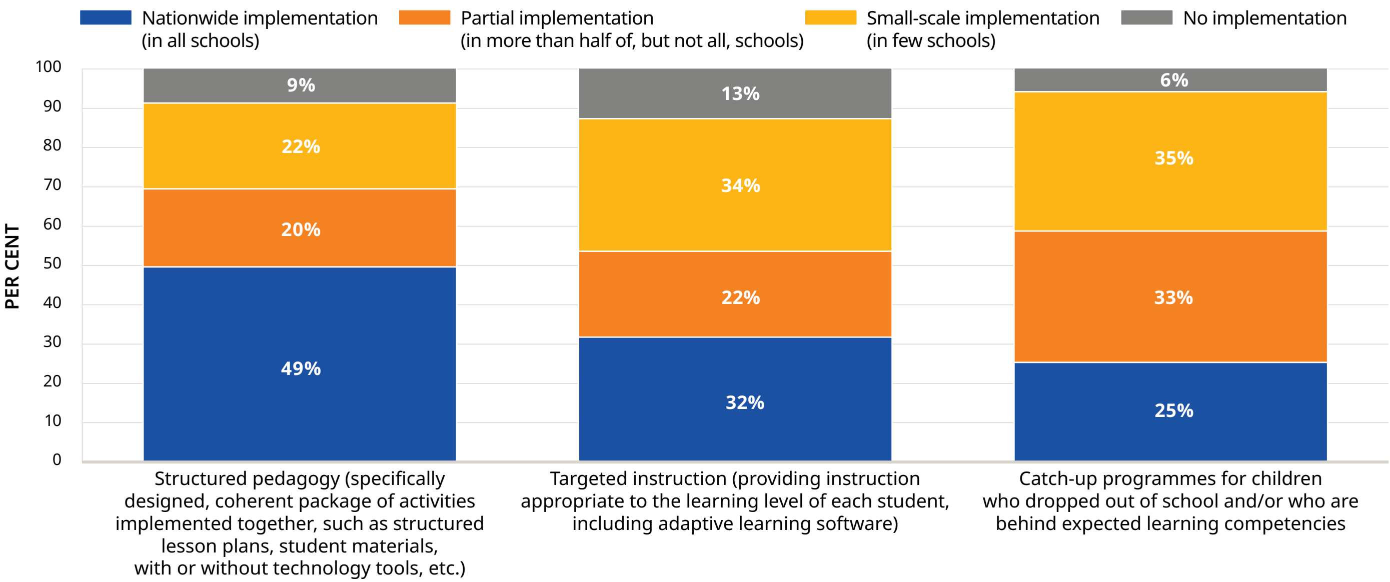
- Structured pedagogy (specifically designed, coherent package of activities implemented together, such as structured lesson plans, student materials, with or without technology tools, etc.);
- Targeted instruction (providing instruction appropriate to the learning level of each student);
- Catch-up programmes for children who dropped out of school and/or who are behind expected learning competencies; and
- Effectiveness of teacher development systems.

LEADING INDICATOR: Structured pedagogy (specifically designed, coherent package of activities implemented together) in all schools nationwide, reported by 49 per cent in 2025 (48 per cent in 2024; 24 per cent in 2023).

LAGGING INDICATOR: Catch-up programmes for children who dropped out of school and/or who are behind expected learning competencies in all schools nationwide, reported by 25 per cent in 2025 (29 per cent in 2024; 18 per cent in 2023).

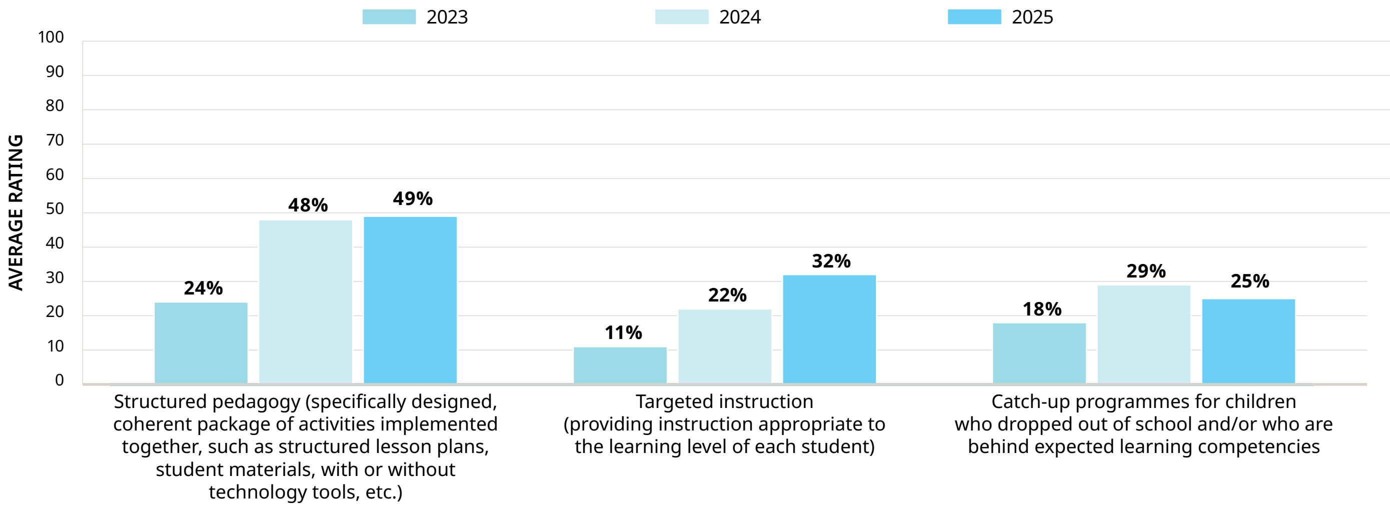
The share of countries reporting structured pedagogy programmes has increased each year since 2023. In 2025, almost half of countries reported that structured pedagogy is implemented nationwide in all schools, up from just 24 per cent in 2023 (*see Figure 9*). The RAPID survey defined structured pedagogy as a 'specifically designed, coherent package of activities implemented together, such as structured lesson plans, student materials, with or without technology tools'. However, interpretations of this definition may have varied among respondents. To better understand these responses, the survey collected qualitative information on ongoing interventions, which include some components of structured pedagogy programmes. Examples include Belize's Literacy Alive initiative, which includes assessment tools and training for Standards 2

FIGURE 9. Share of surveyed countries reporting implementation of 'Increase' policy actions



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2025 survey, with responses from 79 low- and middle-income countries.

FIGURE 10. Share of surveyed countries reporting nationwide implementation of 'Increase' policy actions, by year



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2023 (N=94), 2024 (N=89) and 2025 (N=79) surveys. Definitions for structured pedagogy and targeted instruction, cited within parentheses, were added in 2024.

and 3 teachers; Mozambique's National Reading, Writing and Numeracy Plan, which is implemented nationwide in the early grades and includes continuous teacher training and structured learning materials; and Namibia's Jolly Phonics programme, which uses a systematic approach and includes teacher training, learning materials and regular monitoring.

Fewer than a third of countries report implementing catch-up programmes and targeted instruction across schools nationwide. Over 1 in 10 countries report no implementation of targeted instruction at all. Among those implementing this measure, over three quarters report doing so in classrooms via frequent student assessment, grouping of students and tailored activities, while fewer than half report using technology to enable more adaptive instruction. Uptake of catch-up programmes also remains low: Only a quarter of countries report nationwide implementation, showing little progress since 2024. Given the magnitude of the learning crisis, expanding these interventions is critical to ensuring all children are provided with the support they need to acquire foundational learning.

Overall, while uptake of evidence-based interventions has generally increased, gaps remain in scaling up implementation and strengthening teacher development systems. On average, countries have reached the Established level, the third level in FLAT's 4-point rating scale. To accelerate progress, countries must scale up proven strategies (*see Figure 10*). Furthermore, systems to support teacher development must be strengthened: In 2025, over half of countries report limited or no systems to consistently support and evaluate teaching practices, alongside weak or absent accountability measures for teacher competence and performance. Aligning systems to effectively support teachers is critical to increasing the efficiency of instruction (*see Box 5*).

Box 5. Teaching Smarter: Boosting classroom efficiency

Across countries, significant efforts are being made to strengthen the quality, relevance and effectiveness of teacher development systems. In Rwanda, the Continuous Professional Development (CPD) Framework was revised to reinforce school-based CPD with enhanced mentorship. In Tajikistan, the MoE is reforming its teacher development system, introducing a CPD methodology that shifts from 'teacher training' to 'teacher learning'. In the United Republic of Tanzania, teachers' training needs are assessed at school level to inform CPD, while in Montenegro, a comprehensive assessment of the teacher professional development system is being conducted. Importantly, inclusive education is being embedded in teacher development: In Belize, teacher training is offered year-round on evidence-based interventions for learners with diverse needs and disabilities, and in Mozambique, modules on inclusive education and pedagogical differentiation equip teachers to adapt instruction for diverse learners.

Countries are also implementing initiatives aimed at teacher monitoring and accountability systems. In several education systems, teachers' in-class performance is regularly conducted. In some cases, as in Azerbaijan, the monitoring of instructional practices is standardized through a set of indicators that have been developed by the MoE. Furthermore, many countries have teacher appraisal systems to help strengthen teacher accountability. In Uganda, efforts are underway to monitor appraisals and provide capacity development to appraisers to ensure quality. In countries like Bulgaria, Liberia and Moldova, teachers' attendance is regularly monitored and reflected in data systems, and mechanisms are in place or are being developed to hold teachers accountable for absenteeism.

However, many countries continue to face significant challenges in ensuring teacher accountability, which undermines education quality and student outcomes. Common issues include the lack of clear standards for teacher performance, the absence of systematic and regular evaluations of teachers' in-class performance, and weak links between teacher performance and promotion. In many cases, accountability mechanisms are inconsistently applied, often leaving misconduct or poor performance unaddressed. Local-level discretion and the lack of alignment with national policies further complicate efforts to enforce standards uniformly across education systems.

To sustain progress and close remaining gaps, countries must prioritize strengthening teacher support systems through targeted investments and coherent policy implementation. This includes establishing effective incentive structures to attract and retain teachers in underserved areas, reinforcing supervision and accountability mechanisms, and expanding teacher capacity to integrate tools such as digital technologies to maximize the efficiency of instruction. Governments and development partners must work together to ensure that professional development is continuous, context-specific and aligned with broader instructional reforms. With sustained commitment and practical support, these efforts can lead to more equitable, effective teaching and improved foundational learning outcomes for all children.

DEVELOP
PSYCHOSOCIAL HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

PROGRESS AT A GLANCE

Developing psychosocial health and well-being ensures that children are ready to learn. Focusing on their health, safety and overall well-being also boosts attendance and retention, making it an essential area to integrate within education systems. The FLAT tracks progress in this dimension through the following indicators, with the first four on policy actions (from the RAPID survey) and the last on systems strengthening (from UNICEF's internal monitoring and reporting exercise):

- School-based psychosocial and mental health support (MHPSS) for students (e.g., counseling);
- Recruitment of specific school personnel to support students' mental health and well-being (e.g., psychologists, counselors);
- Child protection/safeguarding policy for schools;
- School nutrition services (e.g., school feeding programmes, free or discount on school meals); and
- Education strategies, policies and plans to address MHPSS needs of children, adolescents and teachers.

LEADING INDICATOR: School-based MHPSS for students nationwide, reported by 42 per cent in 2025 (39 per cent in 2024; 23 per cent in 2023).

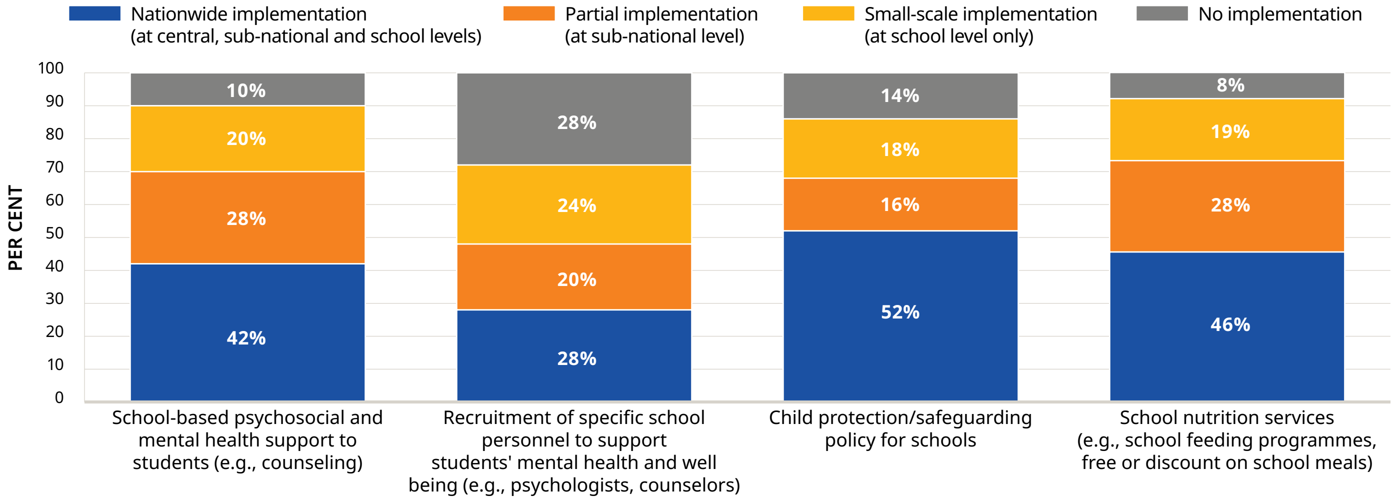
LAGGING INDICATOR: Recruitment of specific school personnel to support students' mental health and well-being nationwide, reported by 28 per cent in 2025 (26 per cent in 2024; 15 per cent in 2023).

Over 40 per cent of countries report taking nationwide action to address children's overall well-being through MHPSS, child protection policies and school nutrition services. Up from just 23 per cent in 2023, 41 per cent of countries report providing school-based MHPSS to students nationwide in 2025 (*see Figure 11*). A substantial increase was observed for school nutrition services, with 45 per cent of countries reporting nationwide measures in this area in 2025, compared to about a third reporting the same in 2024 and 2023. Just over half of countries reported nationwide child protection or safeguarding policies, a newly introduced indicator in 2025.

Just over a quarter of countries report that specific school personnel are recruited nationwide to support students' mental health and well-being. As observed in 2024, nearly 30 per cent of countries reported taking no action on this measure. Although resource constraints may limit countries' ability to recruit specialized staff, the absence of dedicated personnel can place additional burden on teachers, who are often not trained to respond to complex student well-being needs. Expanding the recruitment of school-based MHPSS professional can help ensure students receive timely support, while allowing teachers to focus on instruction.

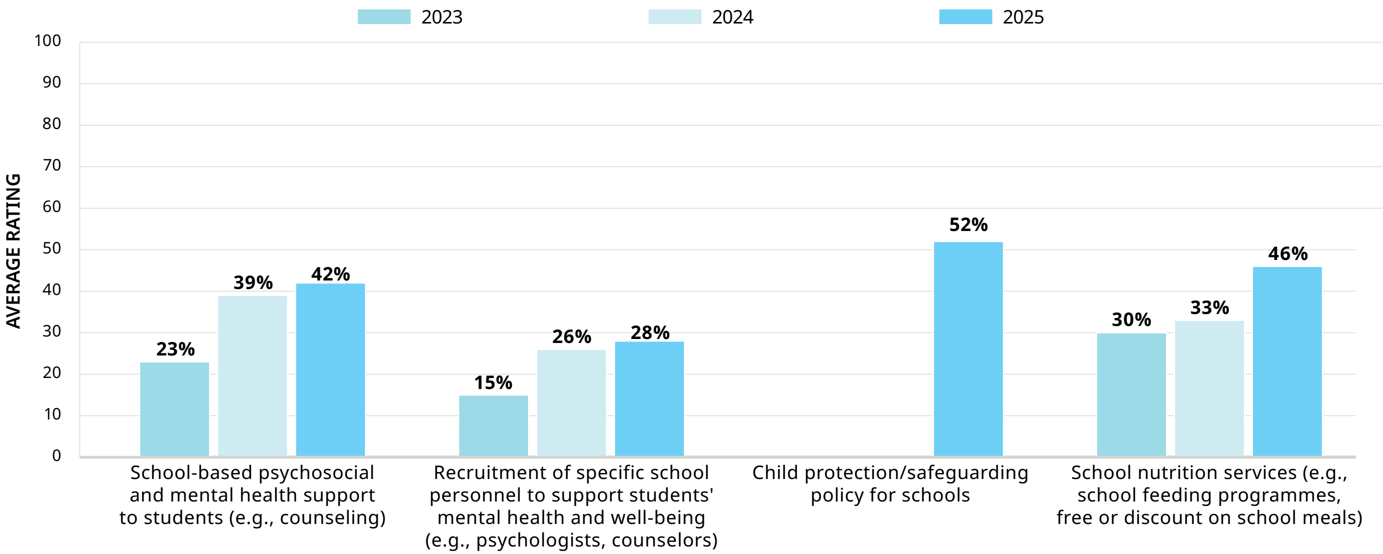
Overall, while countries have made progress in supporting overall well-being, opportunities remain to strengthen essential services that help ensure children are ready to learn. On average, countries are rated at the Established level – the third level in FLAT's 4-point rating scale. Scaling up actions for children's holistic development, including recruiting specialized MHPSS personnel, can help to accelerate progress (*see Figure 12*). It is equally important to ensure that systems are aligned to meet the MHPSS needs of children and teachers. In 2025, over half of countries report having limited or no systems in place to promote and support mental health and well-being in schools through curricula, staff capacity or community engagement. Supporting MHPSS through and for teachers is one strategy that helps build system-wide capacity and ensure schools are better equipped to support learning (*see Box 6*).

FIGURE 11. Share of surveyed countries reporting implementation of 'Develop' policy actions



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2025 survey, with responses from 79 low- and middle-income countries.

FIGURE 12. Share of surveyed countries reporting nationwide implementation of 'Develop' policy actions, by year



Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2023 (N=94), 2024 (N=89) and 2025 (N=79) surveys. Indicator with no 2023 and 2024 data was introduced in 2024.

Box 6. Enabling Learning: Strengthening MHPSS through and for teachers

Across many countries, significant strides have been made to address students' MHPSS needs through teacher training programmes. Countries like the Plurinational State of Bolivia, the Central African Republic, Ghana and Uganda have established teacher training modules and programmes that equip teachers to provide MHPSS to students. Such teacher training is often delivered in crisis-affected areas and emergency contexts, including in Chad, the Congo and the Lao People's Democratic Republic. In Cameroon, teachers receive training in psychosocial support (PSS) in emergency settings, with online PSS made available to all teachers. Additionally, in Zambia, teachers receive instruction in guidance and counseling to address the MHPSS needs of learners with disabilities.

However, significant challenges remain in ensuring the systematic and sustainable implementation of MHPSS by and for teachers. Many countries still lack national strategies or consistent funding for MHPSS, resulting in fragmented or pilot-based interventions. In several contexts, efforts remain politically sensitive, under-resourced or limited to emergency responses. Even in countries where MHPSS interventions exist, there is still a need for their systematic integration in pre-service training and continuous professional development. Moreover, efforts to address teacher well-being continue to be under-addressed in numerous education systems. To bridge the gap between policy intent and practical, system-wide delivery for teachers, countries have an opportunity to build on growing momentum by investing in integrated, well-resourced MHPSS frameworks for both teachers and students.

Conclusion

Countries are sustaining their efforts on foundational learning, but greater urgency and scale are needed to address persistent gaps. Across 124 low- and middle-income countries with data, average progress on foundational learning efforts is at the Established level – the third level in FLAT's 4-point rating scale. While countries are sustaining their strong efforts to reach every child, more progress is especially needed to increase the efficiency of instruction and develop children's overall well-being (*see Figure 13*).

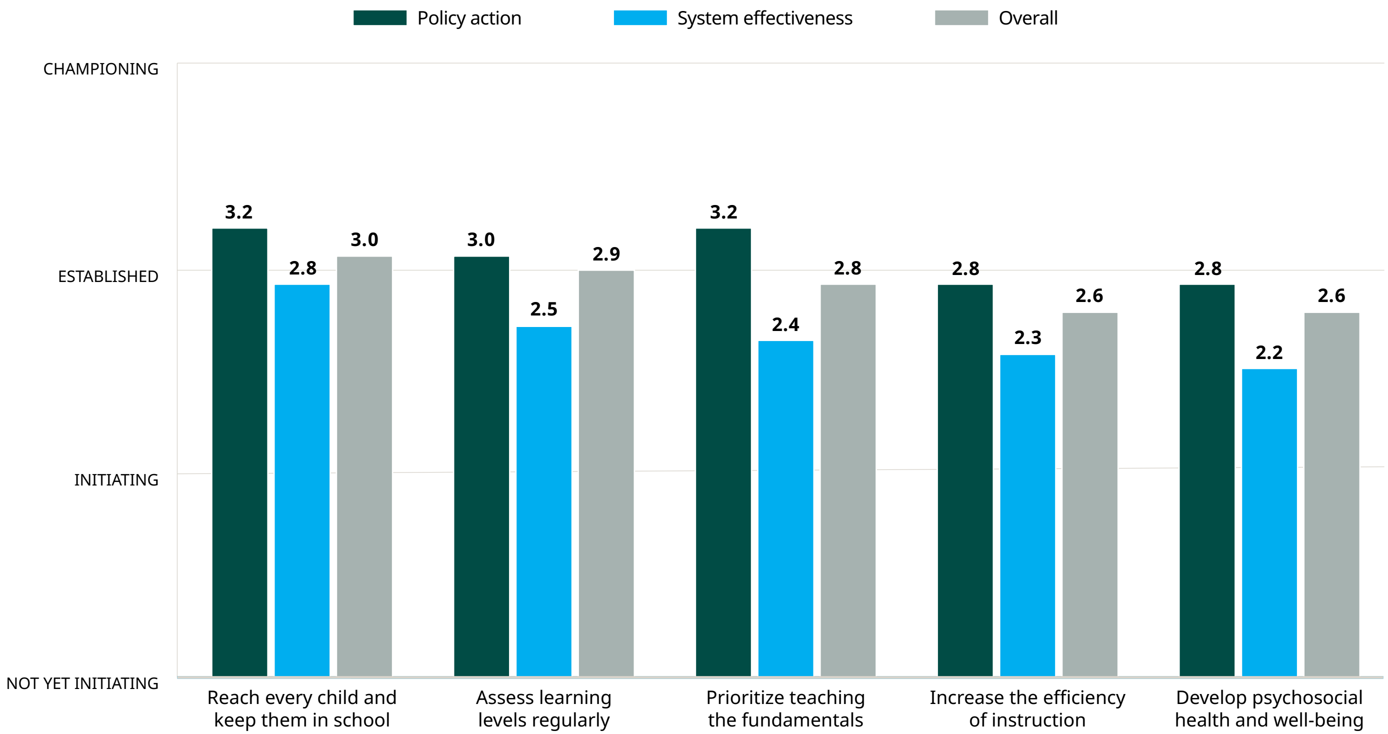
Strong policies alone do not guarantee better learning outcomes – what matters is how well they are implemented. While FLAT ratings show most countries are at the Established level, the link between policy adoption and learning gains remains inconsistent. Learning outcomes depend on the quality and fidelity of implementation, which are often constrained by weak systems, resource gaps and limited accountability. Moreover, reforms take time to yield results, underscoring the importance of sustained implementation and rigorous monitoring.

To transform policy into impact, countries must align systems towards supporting foundational learning. Across all RAPID dimensions, systems strengthening ratings were lower than policy action ratings. Strong systems are critical to ensuring policy actions are effectively implemented, sustained and adapted over time. Without enabling systems – such as mechanisms for capacity-building, data use and governance – even well-designed policies may fail to translate into real improvements in learning outcomes.

Overall, efforts on foundational learning have remained largely unchanged, indicating a need for accelerated action. Only about 1 in 10 countries have shown substantial improvements in their FLAT ratings compared to 2024, while almost all others have remained stable in their efforts. In comparison, almost a quarter of countries showed progress between 2023 and 2024, suggesting that momentum is slowing. A renewed focus, along with scaled-up policies and enabling systems, is urgently needed.

Greater action is needed to tackle the learning crisis, particularly for countries where learning outcomes remain poor. Around two thirds of children worldwide are estimated to be in learning poverty, with the crisis particularly severe in Africa, where about 4 in 5 children are affected.[7] Figure 14 compares learning poverty rates with the level of government efforts to support foundational learning, as reflected by FLAT 2025 ratings, for 71 countries with available data. Africa faces a dual challenge: The

FIGURE 13. FLAT ratings, by RAPID dimension

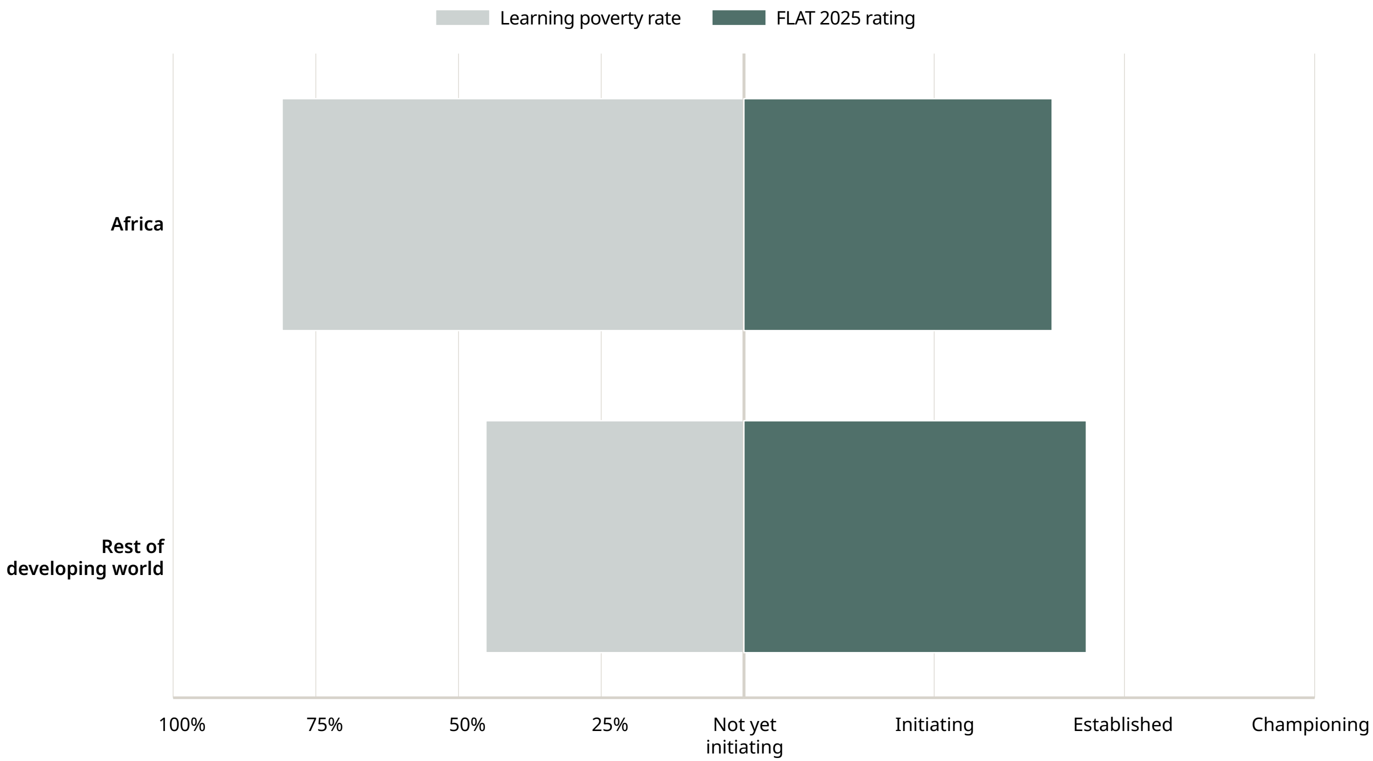


Source: UNICEF's RAPID 2025 survey (data on policy action) and internal monitoring and reporting exercise (data on systems strengthening). Updated 2024 ratings were used for countries without data in 2025.

continent lags the rest of the developing world not only in learning outcomes, but also in government actions to improve foundational learning. Without concrete, scaled-up efforts, this gap could widen further. Reducing high learning poverty rates in Africa will likely require even stronger, more ambitious actions than the current average level seen in the rest of the developing world.

Finally, prioritizing foundational learning in education budgets is essential to turning commitments into action. Targeting funding to foundational learning also increases the likelihood that resources reach the poorest learners, who are most represented in lower levels of education.[8] Some countries are already taking concrete steps: In Sierra Leone, for instance, a 1 per cent surcharge on withholding taxes has been introduced to create a dedicated domestic fund for education.[9] To support such efforts, the RAPID Framework offers a cost-effective and holistic approach to ensure all children acquire foundational learning (*see* Box 7).

FIGURE 14. Learning poverty rates and FLAT 2025 ratings, Africa vs. the rest of the developing world



Source: World Bank Learning Poverty Database and FLAT 2025. Graph represents 71 low- and middle-income countries with both learning poverty data (weighted by pop. 10–14) and FLAT 2025 rating.

Box 7. Investing Wisely, Supporting Fully: Using Smart Buys to support RAPID action on foundational learning

Given the scale of the learning crisis and the resource constraints faced across countries, governments must invest in the most cost-effective interventions to improve learning. In 2023, the Global Education Evidence Advisory Panel (GEEAP) launched a report identifying 'smart buys' – the most cost-effective, evidence-based interventions to improve education outcomes in low- and middle-income countries.[10] These smart buys align with the five dimensions of the RAPID Framework, highlighting the importance of providing holistic, coordinated support to address foundational learning (*see Table 3*).

Cost-effective interventions on widening education access can be implemented to reach every child, especially the most disadvantaged. Providing information to parents and children on the benefits, costs and quality of education (e.g., via text messages, videos, parents' meetings, school report cards) can help increase attendance and improve learning at low cost. Additionally, in contexts where education access is low, cost-effective interventions include those that reduce travel times to schools, such as through setting up community schools or providing transport. To improve equity in school participation, merit-based scholarships, cash payments and prizes targeted at disadvantaged children can be provided.

Regular assessment is an important step in evidence-based strategies such as structured pedagogy and targeted instruction. Many structured pedagogy programmes include support to teachers to conduct continuous assessments, enabling them to adjust their instruction based on students' learning progress and to respond to the varied skill levels in their classrooms. Similarly, assessment is a crucial step in implementing targeted instruction programmes such as Teaching at the Right Level (TaRL), where teachers conduct one-on-one oral assessments to group and regroup students by their current learning levels. Data from the assessments are also frequently reviewed at the sub-district level to inform wider programme delivery and course corrections.

Prioritizing early learning in the foundational years delivers high returns and sets the stage for future learning. Among the most cost-effective interventions is providing parent-directed early childhood simulation programmes for children aged 0 to 36 months. Evidence shows that such interventions contribute to a range of positive outcomes including children's cognition, language, educational attainment, mental health and earnings in adulthood. Furthermore, studies show that providing

TABLE 3. Alignment between RAPID Framework dimensions and Smart Buys

RAPID DIMENSION	SMART BUY
Reach every child and keep them in school	Providing information on the benefits, costs and quality of education
	Reducing travel times to schools
	Giving merit-based scholarships to disadvantaged children and youth
Assess learning levels regularly	Supporting teachers with structured pedagogy (a package that includes structured lesson plans, learning materials and ongoing teacher support)
	Targeting teaching instruction by learning level, not grade (in or out of school)
Prioritize teaching the fundamentals	Providing parent-directed early childhood simulation programmes (for ages 0 to 36 months)
	Providing quality pre-primary education (for ages 3 to 5 years)
Increase the efficiency of instruction	Supporting teachers with structured pedagogy (a package that includes structured lesson plans, learning materials and ongoing teacher support)
	Targeting teaching instruction by learning level, not grade (in or out of school)
Develop psychosocial health and well-being	Administering school-based mass deworming where worm-load is high

Note: The smart buys presented in this table include interventions categorized as 'great buys' (interventions that are highly cost-effective and supported by a strong body of evidence) and 'good buys' (interventions with good evidence that they can be highly cost-effective across a variety of contexts).

high-quality pre-primary education for children aged 3 to 5 years can result in gains in learning and cognitive skills in low- and middle-income countries, as well as long-term economic benefits in middle- and high-income countries.

Equipping teachers with evidence-based pedagogical approaches like structured pedagogy and targeted instruction is a cost-effective way to increase instructional efficiency. Structured pedagogy programmes provide a coherent package of interventions including lesson plans, learning materials, skills-based ongoing teacher training and teacher mentoring. These interventions are designed to ensure that classroom instruction builds on prior learning and delivered with clarity. Another cost-effective intervention is targeted instruction, which enables teachers to group children by learning level and adapt their teaching accordingly. Targeted instruction programmes such as TaRL have shown large gains in foundational learning when implemented with fidelity and support.

Addressing children's overall well-being through cost-effective interventions such as school-based mass deworming can help increase attendance. In contexts with high worm-load, mass treatment for parasitic worms has been shown to improve school attendance and have positive impacts on labor market outcomes. Other school-based approaches – such as providing mass treatment for specific health conditions, safeguarding students from violence and teaching socio-emotional and life skills – show promise, but current evidence on their scalability and cost-effectiveness remain limited.

While it is critical that countries invest in what works, such interventions should not be implemented piecemeal but rather in coordination to support learning. Evidence from a randomized control trial in Côte d'Ivoire found that the impacts of a TaRL programme varied by teacher and school factors: Effects were significantly smaller in classrooms where teachers reported high levels of burnout, and larger in schools with better infrastructure – possibly due to better student and teacher attendance.[11] In Kenya, an evaluation of the Primary Math and Reading Initiative found that teacher training and instructional support alone did not improve learning outcomes, but when combined with structured lesson plans and a 1:1 ratio of student books, the intervention had medium to large effects on learning.[12] Similarly, expanding access to pre-primary education must be accompanied by efforts to improve teaching quality. For instance, a professional development programme for Colombian pre-school teachers led to significant gains in children's cognitive development, especially among disadvantaged learners.[13]

Smart buys are most effective when embedded in a systemic approach that addresses the range of factors essential to foundational learning, as outlined in the RAPID Framework. The RAPID Framework offers a holistic strategy through which smart buys can be implemented in coordinated ways to fully support all children and teachers. Aligning smart buys with the RAPID Framework can maximize their impact on foundational learning, ensuring investments are not only cost-effective but also sustainable and transformative.

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Annex: Country results

Table 4 below presents the FLAT 2025 ratings by country, including high-income countries, along with the changes in ratings since 2024.

TABLE 4. FLAT 2025 ratings, by country

RATING SCALE	Not yet initiating	Initiating	Established	Championing	No data
COLOR KEY					

▲	Increase since 2024
▼	Decrease since 2024
—	No change since 2024
–	No 2024 data

COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Afghanistan	1.6	—	2.0	▼	1.4	—	2.3	—	1.7	—	1.3	▼
Albania	3.0	—	3.7	—	2.8	—	3.1	—	2.2	—	2.8	▼
Algeria*	3.0	—	3.1	—	3.2	—	3.3	—	3.3	—	2.9	▼
Angola	2.4	▼	2.7	—	2.3	▼	4.0	—	2.4	▼	1.4	▼
Anguilla		–		–		–		–		–		–
Antigua and Barbuda	3.8	–	3.0	–	4.0	–	4.0	–	3.7	–	3.7	–
Argentina	3.4	—	4.0	—	3.9	▲	3.0	—	2.6	—	3.3	—
Armenia	3.4	—	3.3	—	2.6	—	3.7	—	3.7	—	3.3	▲
Azerbaijan*	2.8	—	2.3	—	3.4	—	3.0	—	3.3	—	3.0	—
Bahrain		–		–		–		–		–		–
Bangladesh*	2.8	—	2.8	—	2.7	—	3.5	—	2.0	—	1.8	—
Barbados	3.4	—	2.3	▼	4.0	▲	4.0	—	3.7	—	3.3	—
Belarus*	3.4	—	3.5	—	3.7	—	2.5	—	3.0	—	2.9	—
Belize	3.2	—	4.0	—	2.1	—	3.3	—	4.0	—	3.3	—
Benin*	2.6	—	3.1	—	3.1	▲	2.6	▲	2.3	—	2.0	—
Bhutan	3.6	—	3.3	▼	3.7	—	3.8	▲	2.8	—	4.0	▲
Bolivia (Plurinational State of)*	2.2	—	2.8	—	2.4	—	2.8	▲	1.3	▼	1.6	▲
Bosnia and Herzegovina*	2.0	—	2.3	▼	1.9	—	2.0	—	1.8	—	2.0	—
Botswana	3.8	–	4.0	–	3.6	–	3.3	–	4.0	–	4.0	–
Brazil	3.8	—	3.5	—	3.0	—	3.5	—	4.0	—	3.8	—
British Virgin Islands		–		–		–		–		–		–

COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Bulgaria	3.6	—	3.6	—	3.4	—	3.5	—	3.7	—	3.0	—
Burkina Faso	3.4	—	3.5	—	3.2	—	3.5	—	3.3	—	3.2	—
Burundi	2.8	—	3.4	—	2.7	—	3.3	—	2.3	▼	2.9	—
Cabo Verde*	3.6	▲	3.3	▲	3.6	—	3.5	—	2.7	—	3.5	—
Cambodia	3.0	—	3.1	—	3.0	—	3.0	—	3.3	—	3.1	▲
Cameroon	2.6	—	3.3	—	2.5	—	3.3	—	2.2	—	2.3	—
Central African Republic	2.4	▲	2.3	—	2.6	▲	1.7	—	2.1	▲	2.8	—
Chad*	3.0	—	3.7	—	3.3	—	2.7	—	2.7	—	1.9	—
Chile*	3.6	—	3.6	—	3.6	▲	2.9	—	4.0	▲	3.0	—
China*	3.6	—	4.0	—	3.9	—	2.7	—	3.2	—	3.5	—
Colombia*	2.4	—	2.6	—	1.6	—	1.5	—	2.0	—	3.3	—
Comoros*	1.4	—	1.3	—	2.0	—	2.0	▼	1.2	▼	1.0	—
Congo*	1.8	—	3.0	—	2.5	—	1.7	—	1.0	—	1.4	—
Cook Islands		—		—		—		—		—		—
Costa Rica	3.8	▲	4.0	—	3.6	▲	4.0	▲	3.3	▲	3.5	—
Côte d'Ivoire	1.8	—	2.7	—	2.2	—	1.0	—	2.0	—	1.3	—
Croatia*	3.0	—	3.3	—	2.7	—	2.8	▼	3.3	—	2.9	—
Cuba	3.8	—	4.0	—	4.0	—	3.3	▲	4.0	—	4.0	—
Democratic People's Republic of Korea		—		—		—		—		—		—

COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Democratic Republic of the Congo	1.8	—	2.2	▼	1.6	—	1.3	—	1.5	▲	1.9	—
Djibouti*	3.0	—	3.2	—	3.6	—	2.8	—	3.0	—	2.1	—
Dominica*	3.0	—		—		—	2.5	—		—		—
Dominican Republic	3.4	—	3.4	—	3.2	—	3.7	—	3.7	▲	2.9	▼
Ecuador*	2.6	—	2.6	—	2.5	—	2.6	—	2.3	—	2.6	—
Egypt	3.8	▲	3.5	▲	3.9	▲	3.3	—	4.0	▲	3.5	▲
El Salvador*	3.0	—	3.4	—	3.3	—	3.3	—	2.7	—	2.9	—
Equatorial Guinea*	1.6	—	1.7	—	1.9	—	1.7	▼	1.0	—	1.0	—
Eritrea*	2.4	—	3.4	—	3.5	—	3.0	—	2.4	—	1.3	—
Eswatini*	2.5	—	3.5	—		—	2.0	—	2.0	—	2.2	—
Ethiopia*	2.4	—	2.3	▼	2.8	—	3.3	—	2.0	—	2.4	▲
Fiji	2.8	▲	2.6	▲	1.6	—	3.7	—	1.0	—	3.5	—
Gabon*	2.8	—	3.5	—	3.9	—	2.3	—	2.7	—	1.3	—
Gambia	2.2	—	2.9	—	2.4	▼	1.8	▼	2.0	—	2.3	—
Georgia*	3.2	—	2.6	—	2.7	—	3.8	—	2.7	—	2.5	—
Ghana*	3.2	—	3.6	—	3.0	—	2.8	—	3.3	—	3.0	—
Greece*	2.7	—		—		—	2.5	▲	2.8	—	2.3	—
Grenada	3.2	—	4.0	—	2.7	—	4.0	—	1.3	—	3.5	—
Guatemala	3.4	—	2.8	—	3.7	—	3.3	—	3.7	—	2.8	—
Guinea	2.4	—	3.1	—	2.0	—	3.3	—	1.7	—	2.0	—

COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Guinea-Bissau	2.0	—	2.5	—	1.6	—	2.3	—	1.9	—	2.0	—
Guyana	3.4	—	4.0	—	3.6	—	3.3	▲	3.3	—	2.8	▲
Haiti	2.6	▲	3.1	—	2.7	▲	2.6	—	2.3	▲	2.4	▲
Honduras	2.4	—	3.3	—	2.3	—	2.1	▲	2.3	—	2.6	—
India	3.0	—	3.2	—	3.4	▲	3.3	—	3.3	▲	2.8	—
Indonesia	3.6	—	3.7	—	3.1	—	3.7	—	3.3	—	3.8	▲
Iran (Islamic Republic of)	2.2	—	3.0	▲	1.0	▼	3.0	▲	2.3	—	2.2	—
Iraq*	2.8	—	3.4	—	2.5	—	2.5	—	3.2	—	2.4	—
Jamaica	3.8	—	3.8	—	4.0	—	3.5	—	3.5	—	3.4	—
Jordan	2.6	—	2.3	—	2.0	—	2.8	—	2.9	▲	3.1	▲
Kazakhstan*	3.0	—	3.1	—	3.2	—	2.7	—	3.0	—	3.4	—
Kenya	3.0	—	3.3	—	3.7	—	3.1	▼	2.0	▼	3.0	—
Kiribati	3.0	▲	2.7	▲		—		—		—		—
Kosovo*	3.2	—	2.8	—	3.6	—	3.0	—	3.3	—	3.0	—
Kuwait*	2.6	—	2.7	—	2.1	—	2.8	—	2.2	—	3.0	▼
Kyrgyzstan*	3.0	—	3.2	—	2.6	—	2.5	▼	2.8	—	2.5	—
Lao People's Democratic Republic*	2.8	—	3.3	▲	3.0	▲	3.5	—	2.3	—	2.3	—
Lebanon	2.4	—	2.3	—	1.7	—	2.7	—	1.8	—	2.7	—
Lesotho	3.0	▲	4.0	—	2.8	▲	2.7	—	2.3	—	3.3	—
Liberia	2.4	▲	2.6	▲	2.9	▲	2.2	—	2.2	—	2.1	▲

COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Libya*	1.4	—	1.3	—	1.0	—	2.4	—	1.3	—	2.4	—
Madagascar	2.8	—	3.3	—	3.0	—	2.8	—	2.5	—	1.5	—
Malawi	2.4	▼	3.2	—	2.4	▼	2.0	▼	2.8	—	2.3	—
Malaysia	4.0	—	3.8	—	3.6	—	3.8	—	3.8	—	4.0	—
Maldives	3.2	▲	2.6	▼	3.6	▲	3.2	—	2.7	—	2.5	—
Mali	2.2	—	3.0	—	2.2	—	2.0	—	2.0	—	1.7	—
Marshall Islands	2.0	—	2.0	—		—		—		—		—
Mauritania*	2.8	▲	2.7	—	2.7	—	2.6	▲	2.8	▲	1.6	—
Mexico	3.2	—	4.0	—	4.0	▲	3.3	—	2.0	—	2.5	—
Micronesia (Federated States of)	2.0	—	2.0	—		—		—		—		—
Mongolia	2.5	—	3.0	—		—	2.0	▲	2.5	—	2.2	—
Montenegro*	2.6	—	3.3	▲	2.7	—	3.3	—	1.8	—	1.9	—
Montserrat		—		—		—		—		—		—
Morocco	3.2	—	3.6	—	3.3	—	2.5	—	3.7	▲	2.1	▼
Mozambique	2.8	—	2.9	—	2.8	—	2.3	▼	3.0	—	2.7	—
Myanmar		—		—		—		—		—		—
Namibia	3.4	—	3.6	—	3.4	—	3.4	—	3.0	—	3.5	—
Nauru		—		—		—		—		—		—
Nepal*	3.0	—	3.1	—	2.8	—	2.7	—	2.8	—	2.7	—
Nicaragua*	3.6	—	4.0	—	3.3	—	4.0	—	3.5	—	3.3	—

COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Niger*	2.2	—	2.7	—	2.7	—	1.5	—	2.3	—	1.2	—
Nigeria	2.8	—	2.8	—	2.8	—	2.5	▲	2.2	—	2.9	—
Niue		—		—		—		—		—		—
North Macedonia	3.4	—	3.6	—	3.7	▲	3.3	▲	3.4	▲	3.4	—
Oman	3.0	—	3.2	—		—		—		—		—
Pakistan	2.0	▼	2.3	—	2.0	▼	2.0	▼	2.1	—	1.6	—
Palau		—		—		—		—		—		—
Panama	2.4	—	3.1	—	2.0	—	1.5	▼	2.0	—	3.3	▲
Papua New Guinea	2.6	—	2.3	—	2.5	▼	2.5	—	2.7	—	2.3	—
Paraguay	3.4	—	3.4	—	4.0	—	3.7	—	3.3	—	2.6	—
Peru	3.0	▲	2.7	—	3.0	—	4.0	—	2.0	—	2.8	▲
Philippines	3.6	—	3.8	—	3.6	—	3.0	—	3.5	—	3.4	—
Qatar	2.0	—	2.2	—		—		—		—	1.5	—
Republic of Moldova	3.0	—	3.4	▲	3.3	—	2.9	—	2.9	▲	2.7	▲
Romania	3.4	—	3.7	—	3.5	—	4.0	▲	3.0	—	3.2	—
Rwanda	3.4	—	3.7	—	3.7	—	2.8	—	2.6	—	3.3	▲
Saint Kitts and Nevis		—		—		—		—		—		—
Saint Lucia		—		—		—		—		—		—
Saint Vincent and the Grenadines*	3.6	—	3.3	—	4.0	—	3.7	—	2.7	—	4.0	—
Samoa		—		—		—		—		—		—

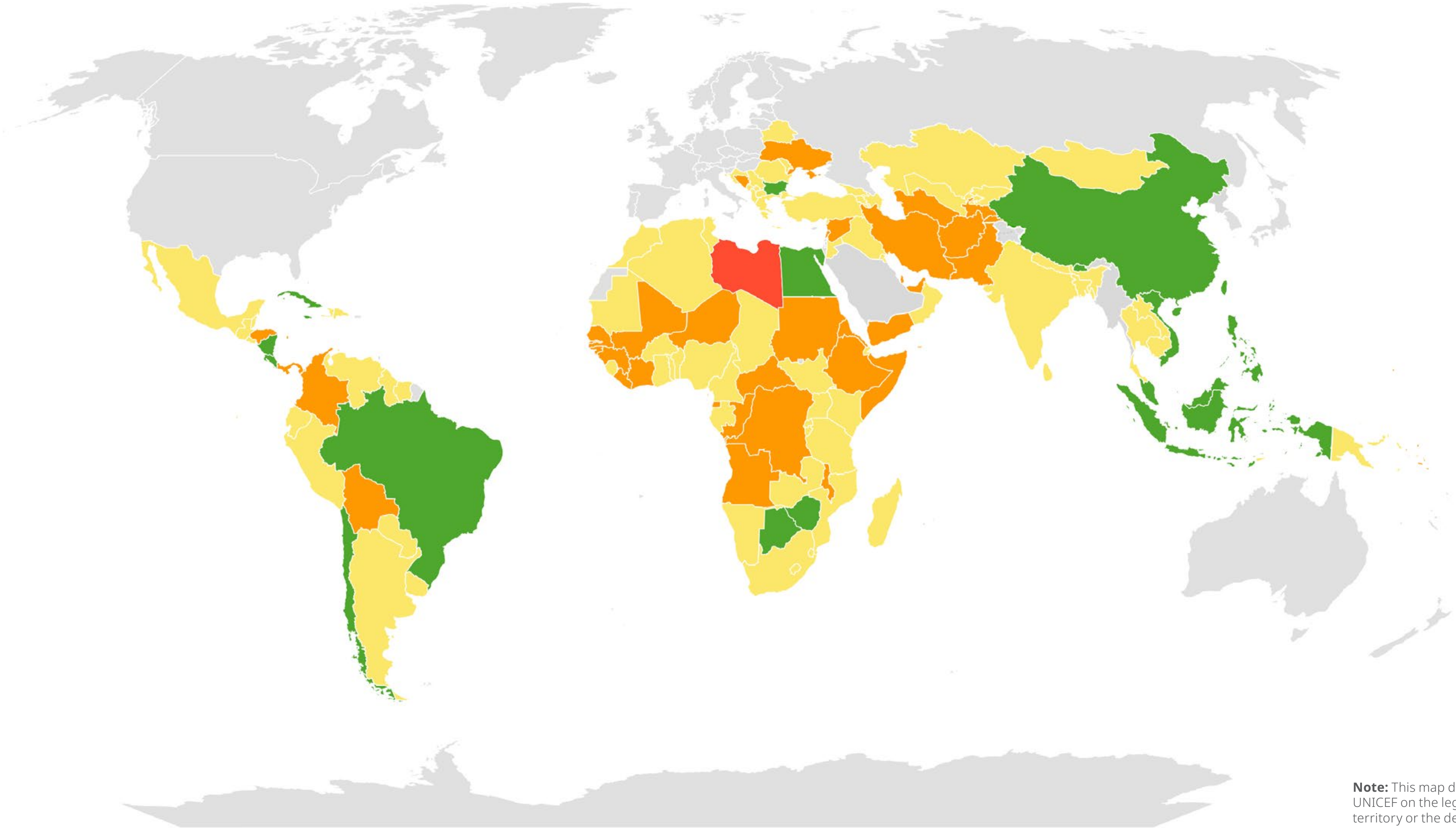
COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Sao Tome and Principe	3.3	—	3.5	—	3.0	—	3.5	—	2.3	▲		—
Saudi Arabia		—		—		—		—		—		—
Senegal*	2.4	—	2.9	—	1.7	—	2.7	—	2.5	—	1.7	—
Serbia	3.2	—	3.4	—	3.7	▲	3.1	—	3.3	▲	3.2	—
Sierra Leone	2.8	—	2.8	▼	3.2	▲	2.8	—	3.0	—	2.3	—
Solomon Islands	2.2	—	2.6	—	2.4	—	2.7	—	1.3	—	1.5	—
Somalia*	2.4	—	2.8	—	2.0	—	2.5	—	2.3	—	2.0	—
South Africa*	3.2	—	4.0	—	2.7	—	3.0	—	2.0	—	3.7	—
South Sudan*	2.6	—	3.6	—	2.1	—	2.9	—	2.0	—	1.9	—
Sri Lanka*	2.8	—	2.1	—	3.0	—	3.3	—	2.7	—	2.5	—
State of Palestine	2.8	▼	2.5	▼	3.1	▼	2.2	▼	2.6	—	2.8	—
Sudan*	1.8	—	2.1	▼	2.1	—	2.0	—	1.4	—	1.6	—
Suriname	3.2	—	2.8	—	3.9	—	4.0	—	2.3	—	2.6	—
Syrian Arab Republic	2.3	—	2.8	—		—	1.5	—		—	2.3	—
Tajikistan*	2.4	—	2.4	—	2.2	—	3.4	—	2.5	—	2.0	—
Thailand	3.2	—	3.0	—	4.0	—	2.7	—	3.0	—	2.6	—
Timor-Leste*	3.2	▲	3.3	▲	2.4	—	4.0	▲	4.0	▲	2.8	▲
Togo	2.5	—	3.0	—	2.7	—		—	2.3	—	1.7	▲
Tokelau		—		—		—		—		—		—
Tonga		—		—		—		—		—		—

COUNTRY	OVERALL		REACH		ASSESS		PRIORITIZE		INCREASE		DEVELOP	
Trinidad and Tobago		—		—		—		—		—		—
Tunisia*	2.6	—	3.1	—	1.9	—	3.3	—	3.0	—	2.3	—
Türkiye	3.3	—		—	3.3	—	3.5	—	3.0	—		—
Turkmenistan	1.8	—	1.5	—	1.3	—	2.0	—	2.5	—	1.3	—
Turks and Caicos Islands		—		—		—		—		—		—
Tuvalu	3.0	▲	2.7	▲		—		—		—		—
Uganda	2.8	—	3.1	—	3.1	—	2.8	—	3.0	—	2.2	—
Ukraine	2.0	—		—		—	2.0	—		—		—
United Arab Emirates	1.5	—	1.3	—		—		—		—	1.8	—
United Republic of Tanzania	3.0	—	3.6	▲	3.3	—	3.2	—	1.8	▼	2.5	—
Uruguay	2.8	—	3.3	—	2.7	—	3.0	▼	2.7	—	2.3	—
Uzbekistan	2.6	▼	3.0	▼	2.3	▲	2.8	—	2.3	▼	3.3	▼
Vanuatu		—		—		—		—		—		—
Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)*	2.6	—	2.4	—	2.8	—	2.4	—	2.5	—	3.1	—
Viet Nam	3.6	—	3.7	—	3.6	—	3.8	—	3.0	—	3.1	—
Yemen*	2.0	—	2.1	—	1.7	—	2.3	—	1.9	—	1.5	—
Zambia	3.4	—	3.7	—	3.6	—	2.8	—	2.9	—	3.3	▲
Zimbabwe	3.6	—	3.6	—	3.8	—	2.7	—	4.0	▲	3.4	—

Source: UNICEF's FLAT 2025 and FLAT 2024 data. Policy action rating for Pakistan is based on survey responses from the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province. Updated 2024 ratings were used for countries without data in 2024, marked with *. A rating change of >=0.5 (<=-0.5) is counted as an increase (decrease).

FIGURE 15. FLAT ratings, by country

RATING SCALE	Not yet initiating	Initiating	Established	Championing	No data
COLOR KEY					



Note: This map does not reflect a position by UNICEF on the legal status of any country or territory or the delimitation of any frontiers.

Endnotes

1 The total figure of 79 survey responses from low- and middle-income countries includes a response from the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province of Pakistan and excludes an additional 9 responses from high-income countries.

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